



ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
GENERAL CERTIFICATE OF EDUCATION ORDINARY LEVEL

MARKING SCHEME

JUNE 2024

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

4005/2

- 1 (a) (i) One word which means the same as having a liking.

Accept:

fond, love

any excess denies the mark unless the answer is clearly highlighted by quotation marks or underlining
misspelling denies a mark [1]

- (ii) Behaviour wise, why some people are usually compared with animals

Accept:

They act in a disgusting / revolting way // Their actions are disgusting // They behave in a disgusting way, ^{synonyms} ^{revolting}

synonyms for disgusting

-abhorrent / distasteful / offensive / nasty

[1]

- (b) (i) Number of seasons it takes for the weaver birds to get to 'wedding' point from 'the time they 'pair up'?

Accept:

Three / 3 / (iii)

[1]

- (ii) Own words for 'several decades'

Accept:

- (2) Many tens of years / a number of tens of years (2),
OR several: multiple / many / a number of (1) quite a few
decades: tens of years (1)

[2]

Zero-few





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- (c) (i) Describe the marriage pattern of the gander

Accept:

It is polygamous/ it can have more than one mate/multiple mates // ^{many partners}
It can court more than one female // it does not stick to one partner [1]

- (ii) The common disadvantage that both the domesticated animals and man have suffered.

Accept:

^{The} Many of the instincts/natural/inborn feelings (they had in common) have degenerated/been impaired/weakened/ruined/destroyed/damaged. [1]

Give 0 for: The instincts/natural/inborn feelings they had in common have degenerated/been impaired/weakened/ruined/destroyed/damaged.

- (d) Piece of evidence which shows that reason is often overpowered by feelings

Accept:

No matter how one is wise/an academic/a philosopher, one falls in love.
// No matter how educated one is, one falls in love. [1]

- (e) (i) What the author observed that made him realise that animals also value property when looking for a partner

Accept: The weaver birds' behaviour //

The female weaver birds' behaviour when choosing a partner // he observed that the female weaver birds choose to marry the male weaver bird with the most beautiful villa/nest [1]



- (c) (ii) What tells us that the sparrow is comfortable in its natural environment even if there are poor living conditions

Accept:

No one has ever succeeded in domesticating it // No one has ever succeeded to make her breed in a cage. [1]

2 Question 2(1+3+1+5)

- (a) (i) What shows that some species of weaver birds are united

Accept:

They build their nests communally / They build all their nests ^{together} (on one tree.) / They construct a large communal roof/nest / (huge) clod of dried grass

[1]

- (ii) In own words, why the branches on which 'the bird town' was built broke.
Focus is on paraphrasing: 'under the strain'.

Accept:

^{heaviness} They gave in to the weight (of the birds and nests) / Because of the ^{heaviness} heavy weight // (of the birds and nests.) Because of the heaviness

Give 0 for: The birds are too many

- overload
- load

[1]

- (b) Two challenges which the writer experienced in trying to get bright pictures of the birds.

Accept:

1. The birds were hardly seen during day time / the birds were only seen at a time when the light was poor [1]
2. The birds moved fast. [1]

Give 0 for: Because the birds keep the same working hours as people do / They only work early at first light until the sun is high in the sky.

The birds were only seen at a time when the light was poor.

34 line lift in para 8 line 5 "They only ... half past seven"

one point



- (c) Why the author's friends laugh at the idea that children develop wobbly heads after eating young weaver birds.

Accept:

They find it funny/ unbelievable/ a myth/ a joke/ humorous/ amusing // It is superstitious [1]

Give 0 for: It is laughable.

(d)

Word	Meaning	Zero
1. hastily (paragraph 2)	hurriedly/ speedily/ quickly/ fast/ swiftly /immediately/ straight away/ there & then/ instantly/ at once/ abruptly	chop chop
2. constantly (paragraph 4)	continuously/ all the time/ many a time invariably/ non-stop time/ frequently/ persistently/ regularly/ often/ always/ continually/ incessantly/ relentlessly/ forever/ ever/ perpetually/ time & repeatedly/ consistently/ again	
3. countless (paragraph 5)	several/ many/ innumerable/ numerous /myriad/ incalculable/ immeasurable/ limitless/ lots of/ numberless	immeasurable/ incalculable/ infinity
4. conspicuous (paragraph 7)	outstanding clearly visible/ noticeable/ stand out/ striking (to the eye) unmistakable/ distinct/ attracting attention	outstanding attractive conspicuous
5. set up (paragraph 8)	mounted/ got (something) ready for use/ get ready for use/ readied/ installed/ put in place positioned	
6. alongside (paragraph 8)	next to/ close (to) beside/ near/ nearby	besides nearly, next
7. look over (paragraph 13)	inspect/ examine/ check/ survey/ skim through/ scan/ assess	vet scrutinise/ observe evaluate
8. splendid (paragraph 14)	fine/ beautiful/ superb/ magnificent/ impressive/ attractive/ marvellous/ wonderful/ fabulous/ awesome/ brilliant/ spectacular, glorious	



3 In the process of nest-weaving, the brightly coated male weavers

Summary points

1. build hollow globes ^{on} that have a hole at one side
2. they attach a short plaited tube to the hole
3. the males attach the globe to thin branches

N.B: Line lift: It is an excellent protection against attack for the globe is attached to thin branches which none of the small prowlers can crawl along. = 0

4. they enclose the globe all ~~around~~ ^{on} around
NB line lift, "It is enclosed all round" Zero
5. they sew and weave with such industry and skill / industriously and skillfully
- 6a. ~~They fly to some palm or bamboo~~
6. ~~they fly to some palm or bamboo / they collect some palm or bamboo strips /~~
~~they fly through the air with palm or bamboo strips~~
6b they tear off a long strip, like a green ribbon
7. they tie the long strip round a branch, gradually forming a ring.
(Both limbs needed to score)
Line lift: This is tied round a branch, and gradually a ring is formed, = 0

8. (from the ring), the bird then begins to weave the ball (nest)

- (14) 9. ~~they constantly strengthen it / the nest / ball~~
- (15) 10. ~~they rush through the air with strips~~
- (16) 10a. ~~they (often) fly a long way to collect / get the palms~~
- 10b ~~they collect / get palms~~
11. some males / the lazy ones / the bullies / the deviant ones sit by their nest
can score in present or past as long as there is no shift
12. they wait until one of these tiny freight planes / industrious weavers /
hardworking weavers arrive
- (13a) they get hold of the (end of the) green strip
13. ~~then, they simply snatch the strip (from the end)~~
- (13b) they simply snatch the strip / pull the strip
14. the little females hop around (13c) they scold and flatter
15. they watch what is going on
- (16a) 16. The females do
the female goes to look over the interior of the house / villa / nest (16c)
hop around, slip inside and look over the interior of the house / villa / nest
- (16b) They do not seem to take any notice of males at all
17. the female marries the one with the most beautiful villa / nest / house // the
female chooses the nest // the female chooses the strongest and healthiest male
18. with some species (of weaver birds), the male builds ten or eleven nests

Specifically
the lazy
ones.
Be clear
on the agent



4. accept line lift from "They only work early...
'half past seven"

19. the females get married to a male with many nests
20. the male weavers continue rebuilding nests /tearing old nests apart and starting new ones
21. the female fetches more building material
22. the female upholsters the hollow/ she lays feathers, hay tufts... /the female furnishes the nest
23. the male improves the rest of the nest
24. ~~he sings non-stop and dances to his chosen bride~~
25. ~~he drives away rivals~~

[20]

STANDARD DEDUCTIONS

A. Penalise every time - $\frac{1}{2}$

- i all spelling errors – but only once for each mis-spelt word
- ii all apostrophe errors, except error in the same word.
- iii use of small letter for capital (every time): use of capital for small letter (once only).
- iv all omissions of a word or words, even slips = I saw big bull.
- v wrong or superfluous prepositions = wrong prep = I live at Bulawayo. superfluous prep = He could not cope up with the work.
- vi use of wrong word for context (e.g. who for which) = The boys (which) were making noise.
- vii comma for full stop or semi-colon (or vice-versa) – She ran into the room, she saw a snake on the table.
- viii single comma at the beginning or end of a phrase or clause where there should be a pair = These men Lester and Frank, deserve praise.
- ix wrongly completed parenthesis, e.g. a dash at the beginning and a comma at the end or when a second bracket is omitted = The men – Lester and Frank, deserve praise.
- x omission of a comma after an initial adverb or adverb clause (e.g. However) = However I believe the man is honest. Unfortunately for the boys they were seen by the teacher.
- xi omission of comma(s) before participial phrase = My little brother being afraid of dogs started howling (only where meaning is distorted).
- xii omission of comma between adjectives = The evening fog had settled in heavy penetrating enveloping.
- xiii use of comma between subject and verb or between verb and object = The angry young man, stood up to denounce society. He provoked, the bull.
- xiv faulty sequence of tenses in the same sentence. He arrived home early but does not see his wife. N.B. Do not penalise shift of tense between two separate sentences.



~~Any grammatical, spelling or punctuation error denies a mark~~

SECTION B: SUPPORTING LANGUAGE STRUCTURES (10 MARKS)

- 4 (a) (i) Accept:
about

[1]

- (ii) Accept:
birds

[1]

- (b) (i) Accept:
latter

[1]

- (ii) Accept:
eventually

wrong spelling denies a mark

[1]

- (c) (i) Accept:
2

get the sentence correctly (same everything) [1]

- (ii) Accept:
1

[1]

- (d) (i) Accept: check punctuation
The author said (that) he was going to take pictures of weaver birds that Monday/that day.

- It was on Monday when the author said (that) he was going to take pictures of weaver birds that day.

- It was on Monday. The author said he was going to take pictures of weaver birds at day. [1]

- (ii) Accept:

No. I do not (don't) mind. / No. I do not/ No. I don't/ I don't mind/ No. I don't/do not mind doing so/ No. I don't/do not mind setting my camera next to yours.

- No, I wouldn't/would not mind

- Not at all

- No

Check ability to respond to the question [1]



(c)

Accept:

1. Look at the weaver bird that has one eye.

using one eye, look at that weaver bird

2. Use one eye to look at that weaver bird.

with one eye, look at weaver bird

NB: Answers can come in any order.

3. Look at that one-eyed weaver bird

~~4. Look at the weaver bird using ^{your} one eye~~

4. Us

[2]